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Sherpa Pros × Building Ventures

The licensed-trade marketplace your portfolio is missing.

For: [BV PARTNER NAME] — Building Ventures Phyrom · Founder · HJD Builders LLC Boston · 30-minute partner meeting · [MEETING DATE]

I.

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The Founder

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Why I'm in this room.

I'M **PHYROM.** I RUN **HJD BUILDERS**, A LICENSED GENERAL CONTRACTOR IN NEW HAMPSHIRE. **TWELVE-PLUS YEARS** BUILDING HOUSES ON THE TOOLS — NOT FROM A DECK, FROM A JOBSITE.

I built **Sherpa Pros** because the platforms my crew gets pitched every week — Angi, Thumbtack, TaskRabbit, Handy — sell us leads we can't afford and send homeowners to people who shouldn't be touching their wiring.

So I built the licensed-trade marketplace I needed:

- **Code-aware quote validation** — every quote checked against National Electrical Code (NEC), International Residential Code (IRC), Massachusetts Electrical, and New Hampshire RSA before the homeowner sees it
- **Instant pro dispatch** — single matched pro, not a leads-blast to 40 bidders

- **Jobs, not leads** — no lead-gen tax. 5% take during beta, 10% at scale.

We're at **[X jobs / month]** and growing across NH, ME, and Boston specialty lanes.

bg right:40%

> *Building Ventures is the Boston-anchored Built-Environment partner who'd recognize this for what it is.*

— Phyrom · Founder, HJD Builders LLC

II.

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The Thesis Match

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Sherpa Pros maps onto the BV thesis bullseye: orchestrating the messy middle of construction.

THE BUILDING VENTURES THESIS IN ONE LINE: *INVEST IN PLATFORMS THAT ORCHESTRATE THE MESSY MIDDLE OF CONSTRUCTION.* THIS SWEEP — SHERPA MATERIALS + SHERPA DISPATCH + SHERPA GUARD — IS BULLSEYE FOR THAT THESIS.

UpCodes

Heather Widman, board. Code intelligence is a real moat — not a feature, a defensibility argument. → Our code-aware quote validation engine reads NEC, IRC, MA Electrical, NH RSA in real time. We are UpCodes' thesis applied to the residential transaction layer.

BuildFactory

BV-led seed, late 2025. Marketplace structure works in the built environment. → Same business-model shape, opposite end of the supply chain. BuildFactory is the offsite/prefab marketplace. Sherpa Pros is the residential-licensed-trade analog — and now also the materials orchestration layer for that residential trade.

Built Robotics

BV portfolio. Labor augmentation on the supply side. → We are labor allocation + materials orchestration + multi-trade coordination on the marketplace side. Same MA labor shortage (2.5% unemployment, project times 7→11 months). Sherpa Dispatch compresses an 11-week kitchen renovation to 5 weeks by sequencing 6+ trades on one timeline — exactly the messy-middle orchestration BV was built to fund.

You've already invested twice in this thesis (UpCodes + BuildFactory). Sherpa Pros is the consumer-facing proof point — the residential trade marketplace your portfolio is missing — and with this quarter's launch of Sherpa Materials, the residential trade-supply-chain orchestration layer your portfolio also doesn't have.

Sources: BV portfolio per buildingventures.com (accessed 2026-04-22) · BuildFactory investment per BV Winter 2025 newsletter · UpCodes board involvement per Heather Widman BV bio.

III.

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The Problem

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The lead-gen tax — documented, getting worse.

LEAD-GEN PLATFORMS ARE EXTRACTING **$400–$800 PER CLOSED JOB** FROM CONTRACTORS. THE LICENSED-WORK FAILURES ARE DOCUMENTED AND GETTING WORSE.

PLATFORM	WHAT IT COSTS THE PRO	WHAT IT FAILS THE HOMEOWNER
Angi	Lead fees often shared with up to 40 competitors	BBB un-accredited · Vermont Attorney General settlement October 2025
Thumbtack	Pros buy contact for jobs that ghost	Documented contractor-deposit-theft pattern · BBB pattern-of-complaints November 2025
TaskRabbit	22.5% effective fee load	Doesn't cover licensed trades at all
Mass Save Find-an-Installer	(free, but no transaction layer)	Static utility listing · no dispatch, no escrow, no review · 3–6 month wait

Massachusetts has the **largest construction labor shortage in the nation** *(2.5% construction unemployment, lowest in 17+ years)*. That's demand-side pull, not a saturated market.

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$400–$800

What a contractor pays Angi for one closed job. Sherpa Pros take rate on a $5K job: **$250.**

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The category-creating wedge.

TWO AXES. FOUR QUADRANTS. THE TOP-RIGHT ONE IS EMPTY — UNTIL NOW.

	LEAD-GEN / PAY-TO-BID	MARKETPLACE / CODE-AWARE
Unskilled / generalist	Angi · Thumbtack · TaskRabbit · Handy	*(no clean entrant)*
Licensed / verified	*(no incumbent serves this lane)*	UpCodes · BuildFactory · ★ Sherpa Pros

The pattern Building Ventures has placed twice:

- **UpCodes** — the **reference layer** for code intelligence (architects, engineers, GCs)
- **BuildFactory** — the **supply-chain marketplace** for offsite/prefab construction
- **Sherpa Pros** — the **residential-execution marketplace** that uses code intelligence to validate every transaction

You've already invested twice in the licensed + code-aware + marketplace quadrant. Sherpa Pros is the consumer-facing proof point — the residential homeowner is the missing endpoint that closes the loop.

III.5

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Materials Orchestration

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Materials orchestration is the BV thesis bullseye.

"Orchestrate the messy middle of construction" — translated to the residential supply chain

Building Ventures' explicit thesis is to fund **platforms that orchestrate the messy middle of construction**. This quarter, Sherpa Pros shipped exactly that orchestration layer for the residential and small-commercial trade.

LAYER OF THE TRADE-SUPPLY-CHAIN STACK	OLD FRAGMENTED INCUMBENTS (BV-FUNDED CATEGORIES)	SHERPA PROS (THE ORCHESTRATION LAYER)
Code reference	UpCodes-style code intelligence platforms *(BV portfolio)*	Sherpa Pros — code-aware quote validation, every quote checked against NEC + IRC + MA Electrical + NH RSA
Off-site supply / prefab	BuildFactory and offsite-prefab marketplaces *(BV portfolio)*	Sherpa Pros' residential equivalent — the licensed-trade marketplace
Materials sourcing + delivery	Industrial-supply incumbents · regional supply houses · same-day delivery services *(category fragmentation)*	**Sherpa Materials** — internal materials engine + Zinc API ordering + Uber Direct same-day delivery (8–12% coordination fee)
Multi-trade project coordination	Enterprise general-contractor coordination software at $1,000+ per user per month *(category exists, residential gap)*	**Sherpa Dispatch** — multi-trade timeline orchestration across 6+ trades on a single project (11-week kitchen reno → 5 weeks)

Compliance + audit posture	Manual COI tracking · spreadsheet vendor records · annual fire drill *(category gap)*	**Sherpa Guard** — Role-Based Access Control + audit logs (SOC 2 readiness signal)

The pattern. Building Ventures has funded reference-layer platforms (code), supply-chain platforms (offsite), and labor-augmentation platforms (robotics). Sherpa Pros is the **residential transaction layer** that integrates all three plus the missing materials and coordination layers — into one consumer-facing orchestration platform. **It is the consumer-facing proof point that the entire BV thesis converges on.**

Per-job economics shift accordingly. A $10,000 labor job has roughly $15,000 of materials passing through it. Take rate stacks: 5–12% labor commission + 8–12% materials coordination + $49 monthly Pro subscription + Property Manager / Success Manager retainer = **blended 18–25% per job all-in.** Materials TAM expansion: ~$540B US residential + light-commercial trade-materials market on top of the labor TAM.

Why this matters for the BV partnership specifically. The materials revenue line is a near-zero customer acquisition cost expansion — every job we already booked through Sherpa Marketplace is a materials-coordination opportunity at no additional acquisition spend. **The materials line accelerates the path to cash-flow-positive on the same Phase 0 ask** — i.e., the same dollars buy more runway than they would for an equivalent labor-only marketplace deal. That is the point we want partners around the table to walk out of the room with.

IV.

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The Product

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Live product walkthrough.

WEB AT WWW.THESHERPAPROS.COM. MOBILE IN TESTFLIGHT (IOS) AND PWA (ANDROID).

Built on Next.js 16 · Stripe Connect · Neon PostgreSQL + PostGIS · Clerk · Twilio.

Three flows. All real. All production.

1. Code-aware quote validation — homeowner sees green "Code-checked" badge, one flagged line item. **2. Instant dispatch** — pro inbox, one matched job, code-validated estimate range, one-tap accept. **3. Stripe Connect payout** — completed job, 5% take displayed, payout scheduled.

bg right:50%

V.

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The Boston Wedge

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Boston specialty lanes — Phase 1, not Phase 5.

FIVE LANES THE NATIONAL LEAD-GEN PLATFORMS STRUCTURALLY CANNOT SERVE.
BOSTON IS YOUR HOME MARKET. THESE LANES ARE OUR PHASE 1.

LANE	WHY NATIONAL PLATFORMS CAN'T FILTER FOR IT	WHY WE CAN
Mass Save heat-pump installations	EPA cert + electrical panel upgrade verification + rebate workflow ($10,000+ in 2026)	Mass Save Network application + code-aware permit-and-rebate engine
EV charger installations	Licensed electrician + often paired panel upgrade ($2K–$8K)	Single-dispatch captures both jobs (charger + panel) in one flow
Electrical panel upgrades	Gateway trade for heat-pump + EV + solar; massive backlog	Code engine reads NEC + MA Electrical; verified pro at onboarding
Old-house specialists	Plaster/lath (50%+ of pre-1950 Boston housing), slate roofs, brownstone repointing	Old-House Verified badge (USPTO trademark filing in flight)
Triple-decker exteriors	Boston-specific code, ISD permits, liability-critical	Code engine reads MA + Boston ISD permit data

Boston is your office. Boston is our Phase 1 specialty wedge. We're a one-hour drive from the meeting room you're sitting in.

VI.

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Traction

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[X]

Active beta pros across 9 trade categories, 3 states (NH · ME · MA).

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$[Z]

Gross Merchandise Value transacted via Stripe Connect escrow in the first 60 days.

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Code engine in production.

METRIC	COUNT
Code-aware quote validations run	[count]
Code violations caught before homeowner saw the quote	[count]
Average dollar value protected per validation	$[amount]
Permits flagged for assist	[count]

Cohort composition (11 pros total): NH/Seacoast — 2 GCs (HJD network), 2 handymen, 1 plumber, 1 HVAC/heat-pump specialist. ME/Portland — 1 painter, 1 landscaper. MA/Boston specialty — 1 licensed electrician (EV/panel/Mass Save cert), 1 old-house specialist, 1 roofer.

Phyrom: replace [bracketed] numbers with live Stripe Connect dashboard + dispatch logs + NPS survey results within 24 hours of the meeting. Date the slide.

VII.

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Why Building Ventures

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Four reasons it's BV — not the next firm on the list.

1. **BOSTON-ANCHORED BUILT-ENVIRONMENT SPECIALIST.** YOUR FIRM'S MISSION: *"TAKE THE WASTE OUT OF THE BUILDING TRADES."* (DEVITTE, BOSTON GLOBE 2022.) **THE WASTE IN RESIDENTIAL TRADES IS THE LEAD-GEN TAX. WE CUT IT IN HALF.**

2. Operator-mentor depth we can't get elsewhere. UpCodes (code intelligence) · BuildFactory (built-environment marketplace) · Suffolk Tech BOOST cohort network. **No other firm on our list has all three reference points already in portfolio.**

3. NE expansion playbook benefits from Mayra's operating background. Mayra Arntz has actual jobsite project-controls experience *(ex-HoloBuilder, Stanley X)*. We're going to scale across New England before we touch any other region. **That's an operating problem, not a deck problem.**

4. One-hour drive from your office. Phyrom is in NH; the platform's first three metros are Portsmouth, Manchester, Portland. Boston specialty lanes are Phase 1. **Real-time partnership at sapling stage isn't a phone call — it's a coffee.**

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What we're building toward.

PHASE	MONTHS	FOOTPRINT	TRIGGER TO NEXT PHASE
Phase 1 — Lean Launch	3–6	Portsmouth + Manchester + Portland + Boston specialty	50+ pros · 200+ jobs · $200K+ GMV · 1 PM anchor · NPS >50
Phase 2 — Scaled Launch	6–12	Full 4-metro execution	200+ pros · $1M+ GMV · take rate stable at 10%
Phase 3 — Regional Expansion	12–18	+ Providence, Hartford, NYC specialty (Brooklyn brownstones, Manhattan pre-war)	6 metros · $5M+ GMV · 3 PM chains · 1 utility partner

Phase 4 — National Scale	18+	Philadelphia · Washington DC · SF Bay · Chicago specialty lanes first	Series B raised; strategic acquisition optionality

Series A trigger: Month 12. We trigger on milestones, not on calendar. The phases are written so the next round is funded by the previous round's proof — not by hope.

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Use of funds — honest about what we won't spend on.

What we WILL spend on (Months 3–12)

- **2 Pro Success Managers** (NH/ME + MA, $8K/mo loaded each)
- **1 Client Concierge** (remote NE, part-time)
- **Paid acquisition test** (Meta + TikTok, $5–8K/mo)
- **Google Ads** (Boston specialty keywords, $3–5K/mo)
- **Platform liability insurance + legal** (1099 worker-class opinion, OpenSign templates, USPTO Old-House Verified filing — ~$15K one-time)
- **Phyrom salary** (first paid month after first close — 60-hr/wk hard cap)

What we will NOT spend on

- **Brand redesign or rebrand.** The brand is plainspoken on purpose. We are not building a Houzz.

- **National launch in the first 12 months.** Phase 1 metros + Boston specialty only. Discipline beats ambition.
- **A second product** (Property Manager tier waits until Phase 2 anchor signed).
- **Conference sponsorship blitz.** Two trade shows max (JLC Live New England, NH Home & Garden).
- **A full marketing team.** AI agents handle content production; humans handle relationships.

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The Ask.

$[X]–$[Y] anchor seed.

Building Ventures leads with $[X]. We close $[Y total] by [date].

We'd start working with you the day the term sheet is signed.

Same ask. More runway than a labor-only marketplace deal would buy. With Sherpa Materials live (8–12% coordination fee stacks on top of labor commission), per-job economics shift from a 10% labor-only take to a blended 18–25% take rate all-in. The materials revenue line has near-zero customer acquisition cost — every job we already book is a materials-coordination opportunity at no additional acquisition spend. **The same $[X] anchor check accelerates path to cash-flow-positive by a materially shorter window than the equivalent labor-only deal — because the per-job economics stack two revenue lines now, not one.**

Phyrom · HJD Builders LLC · Sherpa Pros poum@hjd.builders www.thesherpapros.com

Next step ask: a follow-up partner meeting within 14 days, with a live walk-through on the platform of one job end-to-end. ***Phyrom drives to Boston. You pick the date.***